

LUKAS J. GUNSCHERA

MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit
University of Cambridge
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EDUCATION

University of Cambridge – MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit From Oct 2023
PhD, Medical Science *Cambridge, UK*

Research using computational, longitudinal, psychopharmacological, experimental, clinical, and qualitative approaches to examine social media ‘addiction’ and whether problematic social media use is underpinned by the neurocognitive mechanisms of addiction.

University of Amsterdam Sep 2020 – Sep 2022
Master of Science, Psychological Research (cum laude) *Amsterdam, The Netherlands*

Radboud University Sep 2017 – Sep 2020
Bachelor of Science (Honours), Psychology (cum laude) *Nijmegen, The Netherlands*

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

University of Cambridge – MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit Oct 2022 – Oct 2023
Postgraduate Research Assistant (full time) *Cambridge, UK*

Research spanning computational, longitudinal, psychopharmacological, and experimental approaches to probe the mechanisms of problematic social media use. *Supervision: Amy Orben & Camilla Nord.*

University of Oxford Nov 2021 – Nov 2022
Research Assistant (part time) *Oxford, UK*

Research on selective attention and learning deficits in psychopathic individuals and potential downstream consequences. *Supervision: Elaine Fox & Robin Murphy.*

University of Amsterdam Sep 2021 – Oct 2022
Teaching Assistant (part time) *Amsterdam, The Netherlands*

University of Amsterdam Feb 2021 – Dec 2022
Research Assistant (part time) *Amsterdam, The Netherlands*

Worked in multiple research groups at the university and was involved in all aspects of the research process. Notable contributions include co-leading a large longitudinal collaboration. *Supervision: Bruno Verschuere & Sanne de Wit.*

VISITING POSITIONS AND PLACEMENTS

University of Rotterdam Jun 2024 – Jun 2024
Visiting Researcher *Rotterdam, The Netherlands*

University of Oxford Oct 2019 – Nov 2019
Visiting Researcher *Oxford, UK*

Radboud University Jan 2018 – Sep 2020
Honours Programme & Interdisciplinary Honours Programme *Nijmegen, The Netherlands*

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

**** = shared senior authorship, * = equal contribution**

Gunschera, L.J., Dutton, K., Fox, E., Temple-McCune, A., & Murphy, R. (2024). Overburdening associations: The dependency of psychopathy-related acquisitional learning deficits on processing load. *Personality and Individual Differences*. doi.org/10.1016/j.paid.2024.112705

Turner, G., **Gunschera, L.J.**, Subrahmanya, S., Salecha, A., Eichstaedt, J.C., Palminteri, S., & Orben, A. (2026). A computational model of reward learning and habits on social media. *Nature Communications*

Ferguson, A. M., Richards, M., **Gunschera, L. J.**, Mutak, A., Modecki, K., Goldberg, R. E., & Orben, A. (2026). Development and validation of a comprehensive digital parenting scale. *Computers in Human Behavior Reports*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chbr.2026.101098

Van der Cruyssen, I., Ben-Shakhar, G., Pertzov, Y., Guy, N., Cabooter, Q., **Gunschera, L.J.**, Verschuere, B. (2024). *Behavioural Research Methods*. doi.org/10.3758/s13428-023-02221-2

Gunschera, L.J., Verschuere, B., Murphy, R., Temple-McCune, A., Dutton, K., & Fox, E. (2023). No impaired integration in psychopathy: Evidence from an illusory conjunction paradigm. *Personality Disorders: Theory, Research, and Treatment*. doi.org/10.1037/per0000619.

Gunschera, L.J., Brazil, I.A., & Driessen, J.M.A. (2022). Socio-economic decision-making and psychopathy: A systematic review and meta-analysis. *Neuroscience and Biobehavioural Reviews*. 10.1016/j.neubiorev.2022.104966

UNDER REVIEW AND PREPRINTS

Gunschera, L.J., Mehrhof, S.Z., Veith, C., Ong, E., Davidson, B.C., Vuorre, M., Nord**, C.L., Orben, A**. (under review). Does social media use show established neurocognitive signatures of addiction? *PsyArxiv*. osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/2eqs8

Davidson, B.C., Turner, G., **Gunschera, L.J.**, Orben, A. (under review). Social media reward sensitivity and depressive symptoms over time. *PsyArxiv*. doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/8e3ar_v1

Davidson, B.C., Turner, G., Palminteri, S., Tomova, L., Eichstaedt, J.C., Salecha, A., Subrahmanya, S., Orben, A.**, **Gunschera, L.J.**** (2025). Prolonged social isolation is associated with increased behavioural sensitivity to 'likes' on social media. *PsyArxiv*. doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/65tdz_v1.

Turner, G., Valdez, C., **Gunschera, L.J.***, Valdez, C., Anderson, I.*, Brufal, Z.*, Dillmann, S.*, Fassi, L.*, Monarca, I.*, Ramirez, O.P.*, Tentori, M., Orben, A. (2026). Relating smartphone 'app-journeys' to mental health: A novel network analysis approach. *PsyArxiv*. doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/uytfr_v1

Gunschera, L.J., Achterberg, M., Speyer, L.G., Wise, T. , Orben, A. (2025). Towards identifying cognitive phenotypes of risk and resilience for social media and mental health. *PsyArxiv*. osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/bgqyj.

de Wit, S., Bieleke, M., Fletcher, P.C., Horstmann, A., Schueler., J., Brinkhof, L.P., **Gunschera, L.J.**, Murre, J.M.J. (under review). How long does it take to form a habit?: A multi-centre replication. *PCI Registered Reports Stage 1 acceptance*. <https://tr.peercommunityin.org/PCIRegisteredReports/articles/rec?id=210>

EVIDENCE FOR POLICY

Written Evidence

Orben, A., Purba, A.K., Fokas, I., **Gunschera, L.J.** et al. (2025). Feasibility Study of Methods and Data to Understand the Impact of Smartphones and Social Media on Children and Young People. *UK Department for Science, Innovation and Technology*. <https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/understand-the-impact-of-smartphones-and-social-media-on-children-and-young-people/understand-the-impact-of-smartphones-and-social-media-on-children-and-young-people-executive-summary>

Gunschera, L.J., Orben, A., Turner, G. (2024). Addressing Gaps in Digital Media Research: Pathways for Future Science and Policy. *European Joint Research Commission Report*. <https://publications.jrc.ec.europa.eu/repository/handle/JRC143343>

Orben, A., **Gunschera, L.J.**, Turner, G. (2023). Written evidence for Initiative to protect youth mental health, safety, and privacy online. *National Telecommunications and Information Administration*. NTIA-2023-0008-0001

Oral Evidence

Addressing gaps in digital media research: Pathways for future science and policy, European Commission, Mar 2025, *Online*

Roundtable on Call for Evidence on Researchers' access to information from regulated online services, Ofcom, Nov 2024, London, UK

AWARDS AND RECOGNITIONS

UK Research and Innovation Medical Research Council Studentship	Oct 2023 – Sep 2027
Charles Slater Fund	Aug 2026
Guarantors of Brain, Travel Grant	Jul 2026
Cambridge Philosophical Society, Travel Grant	Apr 2026
Cambridge Philosophical Society, Travel Grant	May 2025
Wolfson College, Travel & Research Award	May 2025
British Association for Psychopharmacology, Bursary	May 2025

Wolfson College, Travel & Research Award	May 2024
American Psychological Association, Editor's Choice Award	Mar 2023
Thesis Award, Netherlands Institute of Psychologists	Mar 2023

INVITED TALKS AND PRESENTATIONS

Dopamine hits? Using methylphenidate to probe the mechanisms of problematic social media use British Association for Psychopharmacology Summer Meeting	Jul 2026 <i>Birmingham, UK</i>
Does social media use show established neurocognitive signatures of addiction? Solitude lab seminar series	Jul 2026 <i>Online</i>
Rethinking social media addiction: The importance of mechanisms of diagnosis and treatment Royal College of Psychiatrists: Faculty of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry annual conference	Jul 2026 <i>Manchester, UK</i>
Cognitive phenotypes of risk and resilience for the relationship between social media and mental health Gillan Lab, Trinity College Dublin	Sep 2024 <i>Online</i>
Cognitive processes linking social media and mental health CERES, Jacobs Foundation	Sep 2024 <i>Newport Beach, USA</i>
Cognitive phenotypes of social media risk and resilience SO-REBEL and SYNC research groups, University of Rotterdam	Jun 2024 <i>Rotterdam, The Netherlands</i>
No impaired integration in psychopathy Personality disorder and addiction conference	Mar 2023 <i>Utrecht, The Netherlands</i>
Do psychopaths suffer from impaired information integration? Netherlands Institute of Psychologists	Feb 2023 <i>Online</i>

LECTURES AND TEACHING

Open Science: A beginners guide Cambridge Access to Mental Health & Psychology Programme	Aug 2026 <i>Online</i>
Open Science: A beginners guide Cambridge Access to Mental Health & Psychology Programme	Aug 2025 <i>Online</i>
Improving Scientific Practices in Cognitive Science: Robust Statistics University of Cambridge, MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit	From 2024 <i>Cambridge, UK</i>
Improving Scientific Practices in Cognitive Science: Computational Reproducibility University of Cambridge, MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit	From 2024 <i>Cambridge, UK</i>
Social and Developmental Psychology University of Cambridge, Girton College	2024 <i>Cambridge, UK</i>
Meta-Analysis University of Amsterdam	2022 <i>Amsterdam, The Netherlands</i>
Scientific Writing and Presenting University of Amsterdam	2022 <i>Amsterdam, The Netherlands</i>
Addiction and Compulsive Disorders University of Amsterdam	2021 <i>Amsterdam, The Netherlands</i>

CONFERENCE PANELS AND WORKSHOPS

Panels

Adolescents in the wild web: bringing order to chaos through research <i>Royal College of Psychiatrists: Faculty of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry Annual Conference</i>	Sep 2025 <i>Manchester, UK</i>
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Workshops

A shared responsibility: Improving causal literacy across the scientific pipeline <i>Society for the Improvement of Psychological Science</i>	Jun 2023 <i>Padova, Italy</i>
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SUPERVISION AND TRAINING RECORD

Research Assistants and Interns

Jamil Adjallah	From 2025
Ioanna Fokas (next destination: MD at University of Warwick)	2024 – 2026
Brandon Davidson (next destination: PhD at University of Cambridge)	2024 – 2026
Emily Poort (next destination: PhD at Amsterdam UMC)	2022
Gustaw Opielka (next destination: PhD at University of Amsterdam)	2022

Graduate Students

Clelia Veith (Technical University of Munich)	2025 – 2026
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Undergraduate Students

Ruxandra Ursache (University of Cambridge)	2025 – 2026
James D'Silva (University of Cambridge)	2025 – 2026
Ethan Ong (next destination: Deloitte Singapore)	2024 – 2025

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

Notes on Science	2024 – 2026
Co-Founder	Cambridge, UK
Cambridge Access to Mental Health & Psychology Programme	2024 – 2026
Supervisor & Lecturer	Cambridge, UK
Pint of Science	2024
Organising Member	Cambridge, UK
Open Science Day MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit	Mar 2024
Co-Organiser	Cambridge, UK

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit Open Science Committee, Chair	From 2025
Society for the Study of Addiction, Member	From 2025
British Psychological Society, Member	From 2025
British Association for Psychopharmacology, Member	From 2024
Wolfson College, Member	From 2023
Cambridge Philosophical Society, Member	From 2023
MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit Open Science Committee, Member	From 2022
Cambridge Journal of Science and Policy, Editor	2023 – 2025
Society for the Improvement of Psychological Science, Member	2023 – 2024
Psychonomic Society, Member	2022 – 2024
Society for Applied Research in Memory & Cognition, Member	2022 – 2024
Student Initiative for Open Science, Member	2021 – 2022
University of Amsterdam, Student Delegate	2020 – 2022

SKILLS

Programming	R, Stan, Git, jsPsych, SQL, MPLUS, Python, Docker, Inquisit, Lotus
Data acquisition	Electroencephalography, electrodermal, electrocardiography, respiration, eye-tracking, ecological momentary assessment
Formal Analyses	Bayesian inference, computational modelling, multilevel modelling, longitudinal modelling, structural equation modelling, meta-analysis

August 10th, 2026

